

Truong Trung Hieu

Game Designer Intern / Technical Game Designer

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SUMMARY

Software engineer transitioning into game design, with 4+ years of experience building user-facing systems and strong strengths in systems thinking, rapid prototyping, debugging, and technical documentation. Moving from outsourcing work into a product team helped me realize that I enjoy owning systems, observing user behavior, and iterating product experiences over time, which connects directly with my interest in game design. Recently designed and implemented **Soko Pipe**, a 3D browser puzzle prototype with 14 levels, progressive mechanics, undo/reset, mobile controls, move logging, and step export for level design analysis.

FEATURED GAME DESIGN PROJECTS

Soko Pipe — 3D Puzzle Game Prototype

Role: Game Designer / Developer

Tools: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Three.js

- Designed a Sokoban-inspired puzzle game where pushable objects can also become traversal tunnels.
- Created 14 levels across 3 chapters, introducing push, straight tunnel, and connector mechanics through progressive difficulty.
- Built a playable 3D browser prototype with keyboard/mobile controls, undo/reset, auto level progression, move logging, and step export.
- Documented core mechanics, object IDs, edge cases, UX flow, and level design rationale in a lightweight GDD.
- Iterated on mechanic clarity, tunnel behavior, visual readability, and mobile-friendly controls through rapid testing.

1945 Air Force — Game Design Analysis

- Analyzed core loop, progression systems, monetization, retention hooks, and difficulty pacing.
- Broke down how upgrades, daily rewards, events, ads, and IAP support long-term engagement.
- Wrote analysis from a systems perspective, connecting gameplay, economy, player motivation, and retention.

WORK EXPERIENCE

SAPP Academy — Backend Team Lead / Software Engineer

Jun 2024 - Dec 2024

- Continued leading backend development for SAPP Academy after moving from the outsourcing vendor side to the product team.
- Worked on a large-scale LMS platform serving around 35,000 students.
- The transition from outsourcing to product work strengthened my interest in long-term product ownership, user-centered iteration, and system design, which became a key reason for moving toward game design.
- Designed backend architecture and core system flows from the ground up, including queue-based processing and DevOps-related workflows.
- Took ownership of backend planning, technical decisions, API structure, data flow, and implementation quality.
- Coordinated backend tasks, reviewed technical direction, and supported delivery across product requirements and engineering constraints.

AHT Tech JSC — Software Engineer

Nov 2022 - Jun 2024

- Developed and maintained web applications across front-end, back-end, cloud, and database layers.
- Translated product requirements into working features, handled edge cases, fixed bugs, and improved system reliability.
- Participated in intern training and source code review, supporting team knowledge sharing and implementation quality.
- Worked on cloud-related projects and collaborated with team members across engineering and product requirements.
- Assigned to the SAPP Academy LMS client project and took a backend lead role before later joining SAPP directly.

- **Tokyo TXBIZ:** Built REST APIs with Node.js, developed a Next.js web app, implemented and customized video player features, maintained UI changes, optimized code, and deployed to cloud servers.
- **Factor X:** Developed recruitment platform features, implemented new designs, optimized UI code, and built an interactive workload calendar similar to Google Calendar.
- **Tocdo Studio:** Built real-estate web features with Next.js, GraphQL, Next-auth, Apollo Client, AWS S3, and Lambda for resource optimization.

Independent Work — YouTube / AI Automation

Jan 2025 - Present

- Explored YouTube content workflows and AI automation tools during a planned career transition period.
- Built small automation experiments around content operations, workflow optimization, and AI-assisted production.
- Continued self-directed learning in game design, prototyping, and portfolio development.

Fabbi JSC — Software Engineer

Jul 2021 - Nov 2022

- Participated in front-end and back-end development for multiple software projects.
- Maintained existing systems, fixed bugs, and implemented new features based on project requirements.
- Clarified client requirements and supported deployment for production systems.
- **Crypto Fantasy:** Worked on a crypto game backend, handled AWS infrastructure, synced BSC chain data, calculated character status, and built workers for achievements using SQS and Lambda.
- **RAPPID:** Built and maintained a medical e-commerce web application using Vue.js, Python, and Django; clarified requirements, deployed code, and implemented Lambda functions when needed.

EDUCATION

Hanoi University of Mining and Geology

Bachelor of Engineering, Software Technology

2017 - 2021

SKILLS

Game Design: Level Design, Puzzle Design, Core Loop Analysis, Difficulty Curve, Mechanic Onboarding, UX Flow, GDD Writing, Playtest Iteration

Technical: JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Three.js, Vue.js, React.js, Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, Git, AWS, Lambda, SQS

Database: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, GraphQL, Redis

Analysis: Systems Thinking, Data-driven Design, Edge Case Analysis, Technical Documentation, Debugging

Language: English reading/writing and basic conversation